

FILM REVIEW

PAA

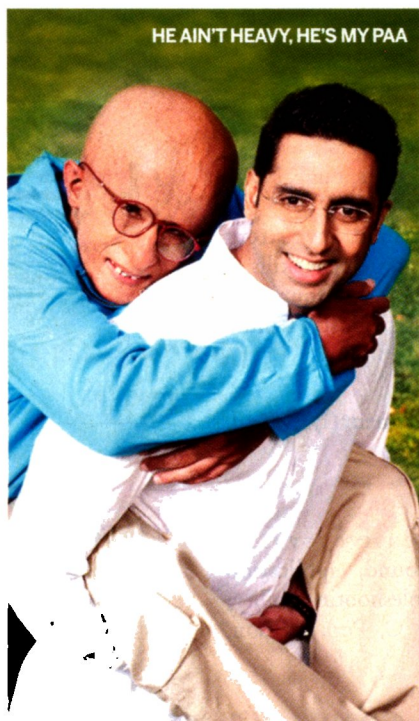
On Olden Pond

RATING ★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆

Director: R. Balki

Starring: Amitabh Bachchan, Abhishek Bachchan, Vidya Balan

Great performances usually require good props. A false nose, an altered voice, a customised mask. In the case of Amitabh Bachchan's Auro, a 12-year-old who inhabits an 80-year-old's body, it is all three. The audience is in an expectant thrall, knowing that it will soon be in the presence of a virtuoso act. Amitabh, still in the hunt at 68, doesn't disappoint. His Auro exists to tap every tear and tug at every heartstring. He lives with his gynaecologist mum and his grandmother whom he calls bum.



He has a father who wants to change the world, one TV station at a time. He has a condition that prevents him from doing what other boys do, from

eating chilly food to playing sports. Everything in his life is touched with the poignant foreknowledge that he will soon pass on. So even as you laugh when he expounds obsessively on his potty and giggle when he talks to his toy King Kong, you do it with a tinge of sadness. What's more, R. Balki's women don't curl up and wither away when their men behave unreasonably. His men are not always unwavering and unshakeable. His children are not too precious or too perfect. And yes, there is the pleasure of watching Abhishek Bachchan playing dad to his real life father. So, what's not to love? If only Balki had desisted from making in-movie mini Idea ads. Cut out the lecture on media ethics, a public service campaign on the use of condoms and yet another podium thumper on slum redevelopment, and it is a movie that could have had more heart and heft.

by Kaveree Bamzai



ART EXHIBITION

Colourful Magic

What An exhibition titled Lo Real Maravilloso: Marvellous Reality.

Who Gallery Espace celebrates its 20th anniversary with this art event. Based on the theme of "magic realism", the exhibition includes a display of video arts, paintings,



WORKS ON DISPLAY

photographs and sculptures by 36 artists from across the globe. Italian artist Anila Rubiku's installation consists of 30 small house sculptures that celebrates domestic life while Dhruvi Acharya's paintings focus on the environment, violence and discord.

When and where At Lalit Kala Akademi, Delhi. On till December 18.

S. Sahaya Ranjit

MUSIC REVIEW

Power of SOUND



SPA SPECIAL
Music Today Rs 299

Music always has the power to touch an emotive chord, rejuvenate the senses and soothe frayed nerves. In its latest album *Spa Special*, Music

Today under three series, *Heal*, *Relax* and *Rejuvenate*, has compiled various tracks from its archives that have been composed by Indian classical musicians like Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma, Hariprasad Chaurasia, Louis Banks and Vishwa Mohan Bhatt. Music you can play while doing yoga or going on long drives. Pure joy.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit